

Amina A. Abdu

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RESEARCH EXPERTISE

AI ethics, law, and policy | science and technology studies (STS) | algorithmic governance

EDUCATION

University of Michigan

Ph.D. in Information

Ann Arbor, MI

2021–2026 (*expected*)

- Science, Technology & Society Graduate Certificate
- **Dissertation:** Legitimacy Practices Under Algorithmic Governance
- **Committee:** Abigail Jacobs (chair), Ben Green, Elizabeth Popp Berman, Simone Zhang (NYU Sociology)

Pomona College

Bachelor of Arts in Mathematics & Economics

Claremont, CA

2014–2018

- Thesis: *Optimal transport theory for selection of Nash equilibria in multiple-equilibria games*, advised by Dr. Adolfo Rumbos (**Distinction in Senior Exercise**)

RESEARCH

Publications

Amina A. Abdu & Abigail Z. Jacobs. Legitimacy Practices, Algorithms, and the New Bureaucratic Quantification.

Big Data & Society. 2026.

- Presented at *Privacy Law Scholars Conference*. Washington, D.C. 2024.

Amina A. Abdu & Abigail Z. Jacobs. AI Evaluations and the Standards Metaphor.

Yale Journal of Law and Technology. 2026.

- Presented at the *Governing Data Symposium*. New Haven, CT. 2025.
- Presented at *Privacy Law Scholars Conference*. Los Angeles, CA. 2025.
- Presented at the *Meeting of the Society for Social Studies of Science (4S)*. Seattle, WA. 2025.

Irene V. Pasquetto, **Amina A. Abdu** & Natascha Chtena. Essential Work, Invisible Workers: The Role of Digital Curation in COVID-19 Open Science.

Journal of the Association for Information Science and Technology. 2024.

Amina A. Abdu, Lauren M. Chambers, Abigail Z. Jacobs & Deirdre K. Mulligan. Algorithmic Transparency and Participation through the Handoff Lens: Lessons Learned from the U.S. Census Bureau's Adoption of Differential Privacy.

ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability and Transparency (FAccT). 2024.

- Presented at *Privacy Law Scholars Conference*. Boulder, CO. 2023.
- Presented at *Data (Re)Makes the World Conference*, Information Society Project at Yale Law School. New Haven, CT. 2023.

Amina Abdu & Abigail Jacobs. Public Administration.

In *Keywords on the Datafied State*. Data & Society. 2024.

Amina A. Abdu, Abigail Z. Jacobs & Irene V. Pasquetto. An Empirical Analysis of Racial Categories in the Algorithmic Fairness Literature.

ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability and Transparency (FAccT).

Selected work in progress

Amina A. Abdu, Simone Zhang, & Abigail Z. Jacobs. Error, Fraud, and Fodder for the Accountability Machine: The Negotiation of Administrative Error Metrics in SNAP.

Amina A. Abdu, Jeremy Seeman & Abigail Z. Jacobs. Ethical Closure Problems in Formalizing Technologies. *Under Review*.

- Presented at *Privacy and Public Policy Conference*. Washington, D.C. 2024.

AWARDS AND HONORS

Initiative for Democracy & Civic Empowerment Grant (**\$3,000**). *AI-Driven Fraud Detection and the Transformation of Government Accountability*. University of Michigan, 2025-2026.

UMSI Dean's Fellowship. U-M School of Information, 2025.

Gary M. Olson Outstanding Ph.D. Student Award – *Honorable Mention*. U-M School of Information, 2025.

Rackham One-Term Dissertation Fellowship – *Honorable Mention*. U-M Rackham Graduate School, 2025.

Distinction in Doctoral Pre-Candidacy Paper and Oral Defense (**top 10%**). U-M School of Information, 2023.

Racial Equity in Tech Policy Accelerator (**\$3,000**). Federation of American Scientists & Kapor Center, 2023.

Distinction in Mathematics Senior Exercise (Pomona College Thesis Award), 2018.

TALKS

- University of Iowa. AI Evaluations in Policy. Guest lecture for CS4980/LAW9871. April 2025.
- Participatory AI Research & Practice Symposium. Algorithmic Transparency and Participation through the Handoff Lens: Lessons Learned from the U.S. Census Bureau's Adoption of Differential Privacy. January 2025.
- OpenDP Community Meeting. Differential Privacy Beyond Algorithms, invited discussant. August 2024.
- Law and Society Association Annual Meeting (LSA). Keywords on the Datafied State Roundtable, panelist. June 2024.
- Data & Society. Keywords and Frames. Public Technology Leadership Collaborative, invited talk. April 2024.
- Northeastern University. Upstream Assumptions in Responsible AI: An Empirical Assessment of Racial Categories in the Algorithmic Fairness Literature. Network Science Institute, invited talk. February 2024.

OTHER WORKSHOP AND CONFERENCE PARTICIPATION

- Sociotechnical Approaches to Measurement and Validation for Safety in AI. Northwestern Center for Advancing Safety of Machine Intelligence (CASMI). July 2023.
- Methods for Inclusivity in Data Collection. Partnership on AI. May 2023.
- Keywords on the Datafied State Workshop. Data & Society. March 2023.
- Who Has an Interest in "Public Interest Technology"? *ACM Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW)*. November 2022.
- Doctoral Colloquium. *ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT)*. June 2022.
- Governing Everyday Misinformation. University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign. November 2021.

TEACHING

SI 301: Information Ethics	Fall 2025
<i>Graduate Student Instructor, University of Michigan</i>	<i>Ann Arbor, MI</i>
SI 206: Data-Oriented Programming	Winter 2024
<i>Graduate Student Instructor, University of Michigan</i>	<i>Ann Arbor, MI</i>
SI 110: Introduction to Information Studies	Fall 2022
<i>Graduate Student Instructor, University of Michigan</i>	<i>Ann Arbor, MI</i>
MATH 060: Calculus I	Fall 2016, Fall 2017
<i>Teaching Assistant & Curriculum Design, Pomona College</i>	<i>Claremont, CA</i>

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Antitrust Advocacy Associate

April 2020 – August 2021

Consumer Federation of America

Washington, D.C.

- Led portfolio on digital platform governance including competition law, data collection and privacy, discrimination, content moderation, and intermediary liability

Research Associate

July, 2018 – March, 2020

Harvard Kennedy School of Government & Harvard Business School

Cambridge, MA

- Conducted data management, statistical analysis, and research for economic health policy scholarship regarding public insurance, hospital networks, and regulation of the pharmaceutical industry

REVIEWING

2026: ACM FAccT; NeurIPS; ACL Workshop on Evaluating AI in Practice

2025: ACM AIES; ACM FAccT; NeurIPS Workshop on Regulatable ML; Statistics and Public Policy

2024: ACM AIES; ACM FAccT

2023: ACM FAccT

SERVICE TO THE UNIVERSITY

Doctoral Committee Student Representative, U-M School of Information, AY 2025-2026

Steering Committee Student Representative, U-M Science, Technology, and Society Program, AY 2025-2026

Co-organizer, Rackham Interdisciplinary Workshop on Science, Technology, and Society, 2024-present

Reviewer, U-M School of Information Ph.D. Application Feedback Program, 2023-present

Peer mentor, U-M School of Information Ph.D. Program, 2022-present

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS AND RESEARCH AFFILIATIONS

Society for the Social Studies of Science

U-M Center for Ethics, Society and Computing